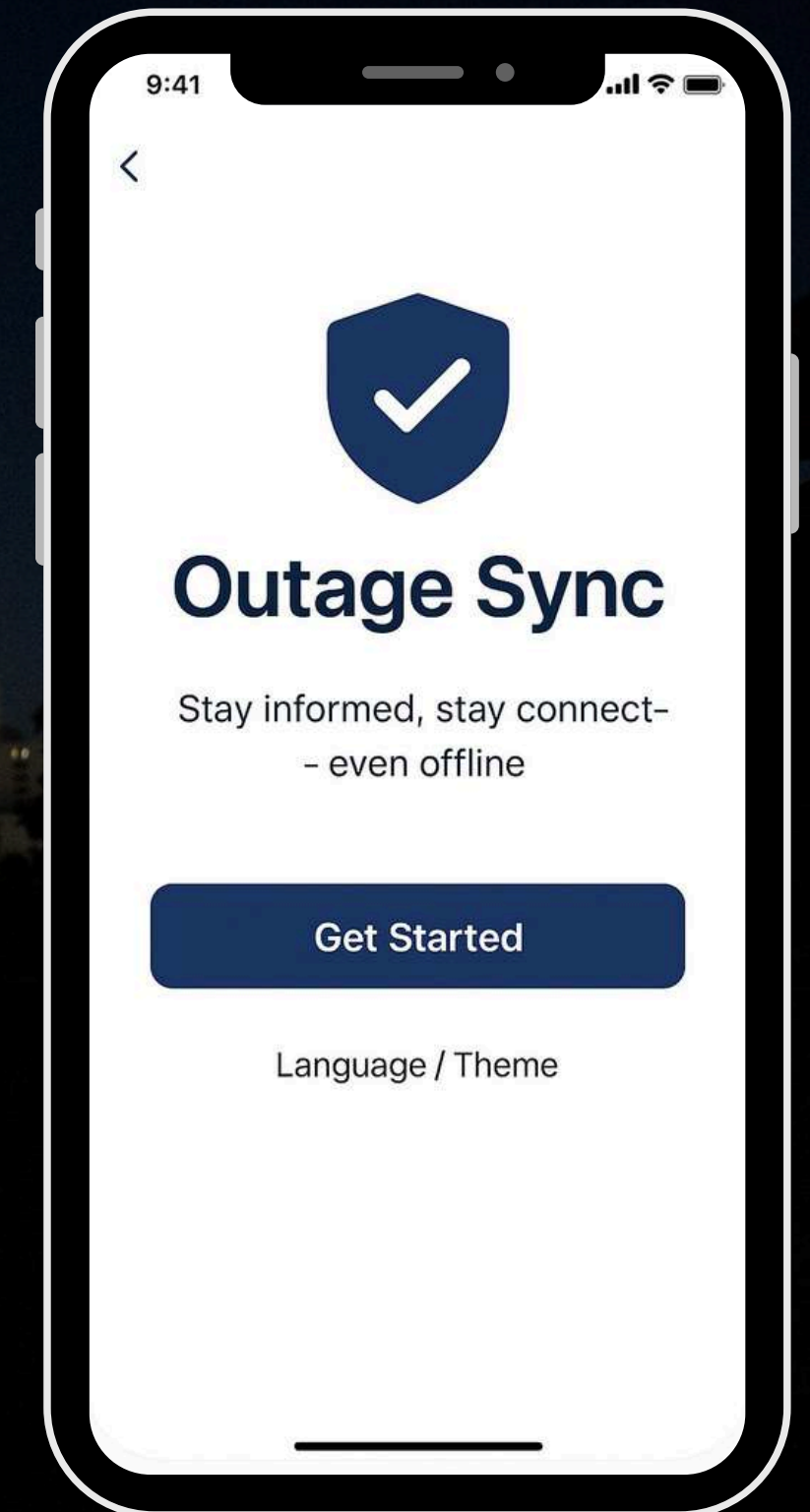


OutageSync: Preserving Truth During Internet Blackouts



Youth Hackathon 2025

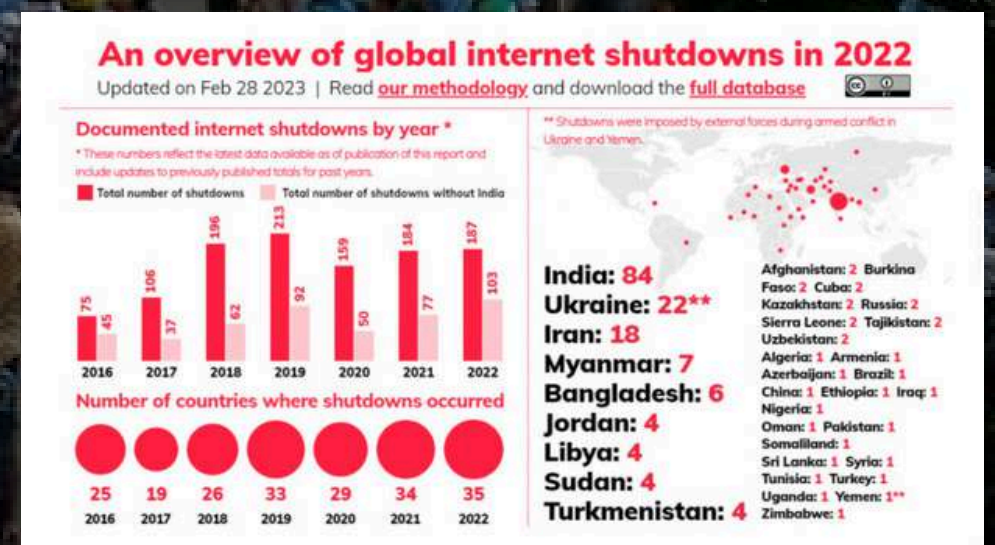


Our Story: When Darkness Falls, Truth Must Survive

In July 2024, as protests erupted across Bangladesh, our team watched helplessly as the government pulled the plug on the internet. Students were being killed, but the world couldn't see. Families couldn't find each other. Truth was the first casualty.

We weren't just observers – we lived through the information vacuum. We saw how rumors spread faster than wildfire in the darkness. We witnessed how authentic voices were silenced while misinformation thrived. That's when we realized: the world needs a way to **preserve truth even when the internet dies**.

OutageSync was born from this crisis. It's not just an app – it's our answer to digital authoritarianism.



Team: Truth Hackers

Our team comprises two countries, Bangladesh and Pakistan, but we all deal with the tragedy of a shared issue. The strategic internet disconnections of 2024 had the gravest economic consequences on Pakistan globally. It took 9,735 hours to repair the disruptions, about 83 million users were impacted, and the losses reached 1.62 billion dollars (Dawn, Arab News, PK). It is this common predicament that has been able to unite us, both the innovators of Bangladesh and Pakistan to create OutageSync, a device that never lost the truth when the world failed to illuminate.



Farwa Haroon

Team Leader & Full Stack Developer



Rabia Ishtiaq

UI/UX Designer & Solution Founder



**Mohammad Hossain
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Communication & Strategy



Sahad Ibne Saiful

Media & MIL Researcher



Hifza Zafar

Mobile App Developer & Blockchain Engineer



Saveda Niaz

Frontend Developer



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Just How Big Is the Problem?

Internet shutdowns at record high in Africa as access 'weaponised'

More governments seeking to keep millions of people offline amid conflicts, protests and political instability



United Nations

UN News

Global perspective Human stories

Oppressive shutdowns

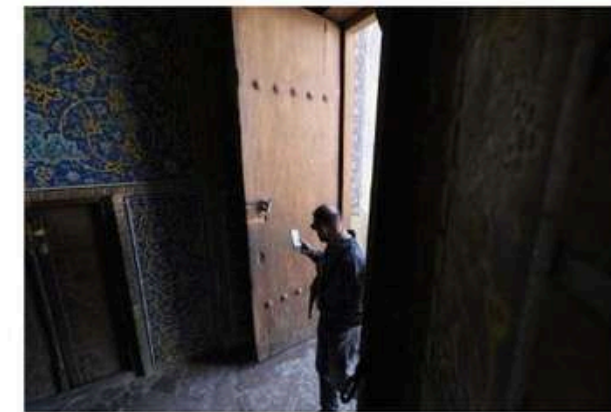
"At least **27 of the 46 least developed countries** have implemented shutdowns between 2016 and 2021, despite receiving support to increase their Internet connectivity" stressed Ms. Hicks.

The first major internet shutdown took place in Egypt in 2011, during the Tahrir Square protests that led to hundreds of arrests and killings.

Shutdowns can mean a complete block on Internet connectivity, but governments also increasingly ban access to major communication platforms and limit bandwidth and **mobile services to 2G transfer speeds**, making it difficult to share and watch videos or live

Iran's Internet Blackout Adds New Dangers for Civilians Amid Israeli Bombings

Iran is limiting internet connectivity for citizens amid Israeli airstrikes—pushing people towards domestic apps, which may not be secure, and limiting their ability to access vital information.



PHOTOGRAPH: MORTEZA NIKBOUZZI/GETTY IMAGES

Violence & internet shutdowns in 2023: the worst year on record

PUBLISHED: 15 MAY 2024 LAST UPDATED: 15 MAY 2024

Content note: The following post contains references to violence.

By almost every measure, 2023 was the worst year of internet shutdowns on record. Authorities deliberately interrupted the internet **at least 283 times in 39 countries** concealing, enabling, and exacerbating violence, war crimes, attacks on democracy, and other atrocities, crushing the **human rights of millions of people**.

Launching today, May 15, Access Now and the **#KeepItOn coalition**'s new report, ***Shrinking democracy, growing violence: Internet shutdowns in 2023***, exposes the unparalleled impact and destruction of these brutal attacks on human rights throughout a dangerous year of extremes. Read the **full report** and **global snapshot**.

HUMAN RIGHTS WATCH

Russia: Internet Blocking, Disruptions and Increasing Isolation

Human Rights Watch wrote to five foreign and three Russian technology companies, as well as to the Russian government about its findings. The responses from the foreign tech company Cloudflare and Russian tech company Yandex are reflected in the report, and available as an annex to the report on Human Rights Watch's website.

Russian authorities have blocked thousands of websites, including for independent media outlets and **human rights organizations, opposition politicians' web pages, and social media platforms**, for failure to comply with Russia's draconian legislation regulating online activity.

Some **foreign websites and platforms have stopped providing services to users from Russia** due to sanctions and political pressure that followed Russia's full-scale invasion of Ukraine in February 2022.

Now,

What's the Solution?

We Need an App That Can:



Preserve Truth

Capture and authenticate media during internet blackouts



Enable Verification

Provide blockchain-based authenticity proof post-shutdown



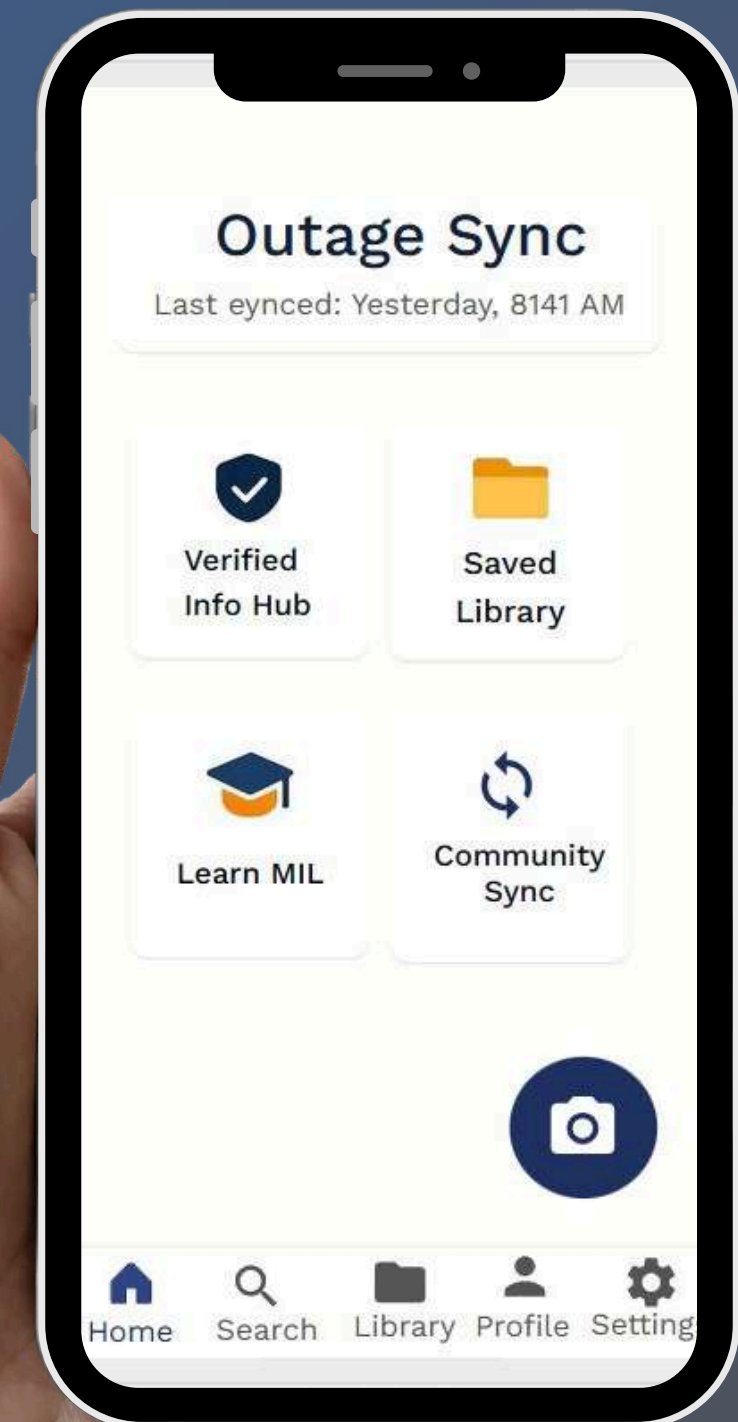
Support Professionals

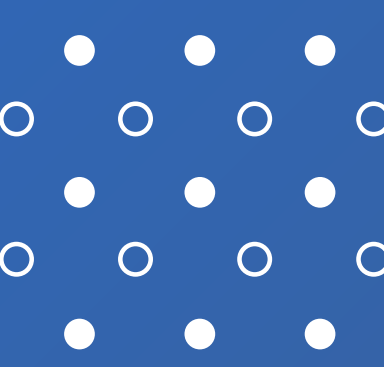
Give journalists and NGOs tools to verify content



Empower Citizens

Build media literacy skills for crisis situations





INTRODUCING OUTAGESYNC PLATFORM

An offline-first, blockchain-verified platform that turns every smartphone into a truth preservation device during internet blackouts.



1. Capture

Record timestamped, GPS-tagged, cryptographically hashed media



3. Verify

Upload to blockchain for permanent authenticity proof



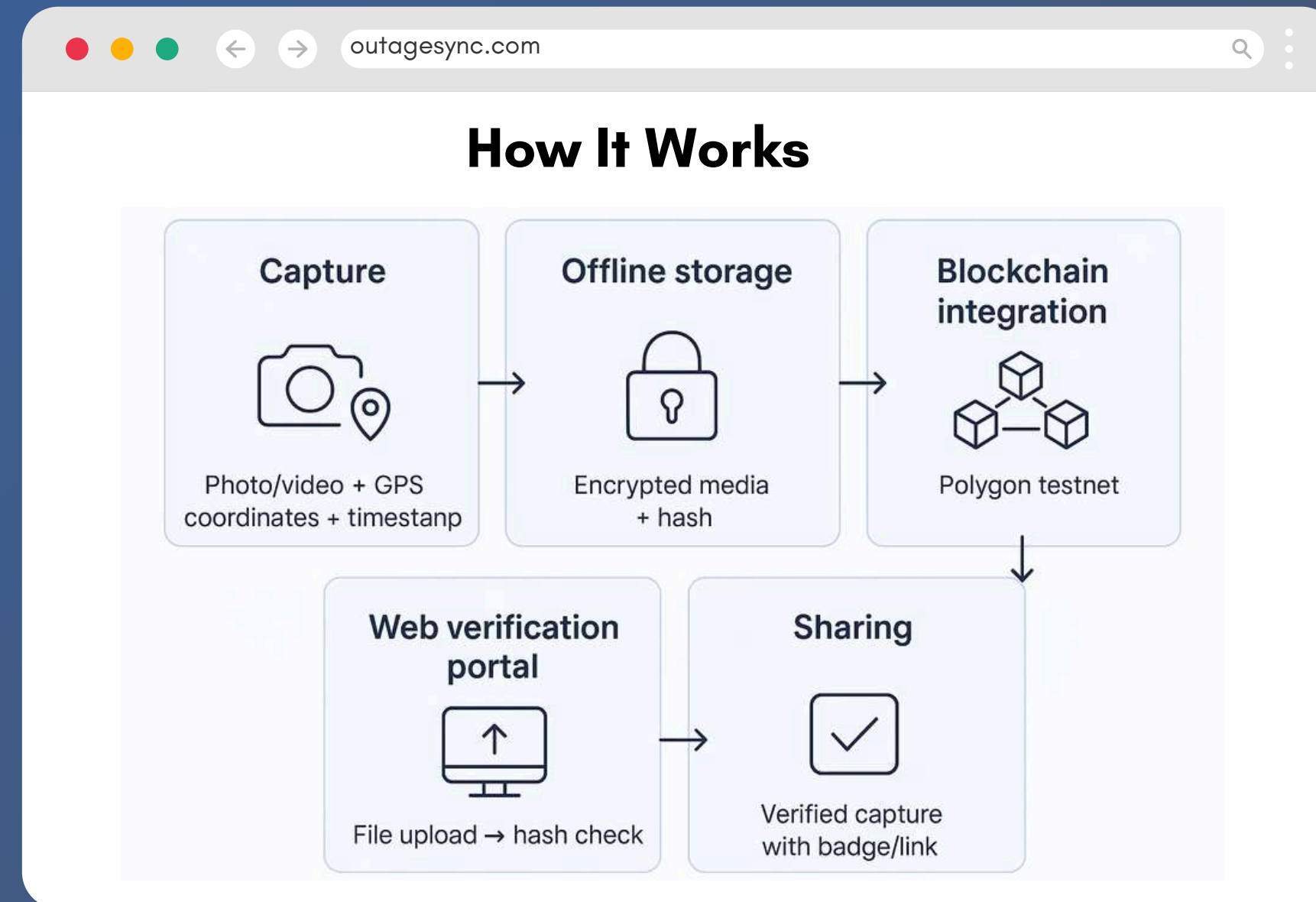
2. Preserve

Store encrypted content locally until internet returns



4. Share

Provide verification portal for journalists and fact-checkers



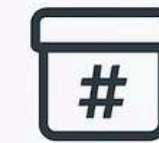
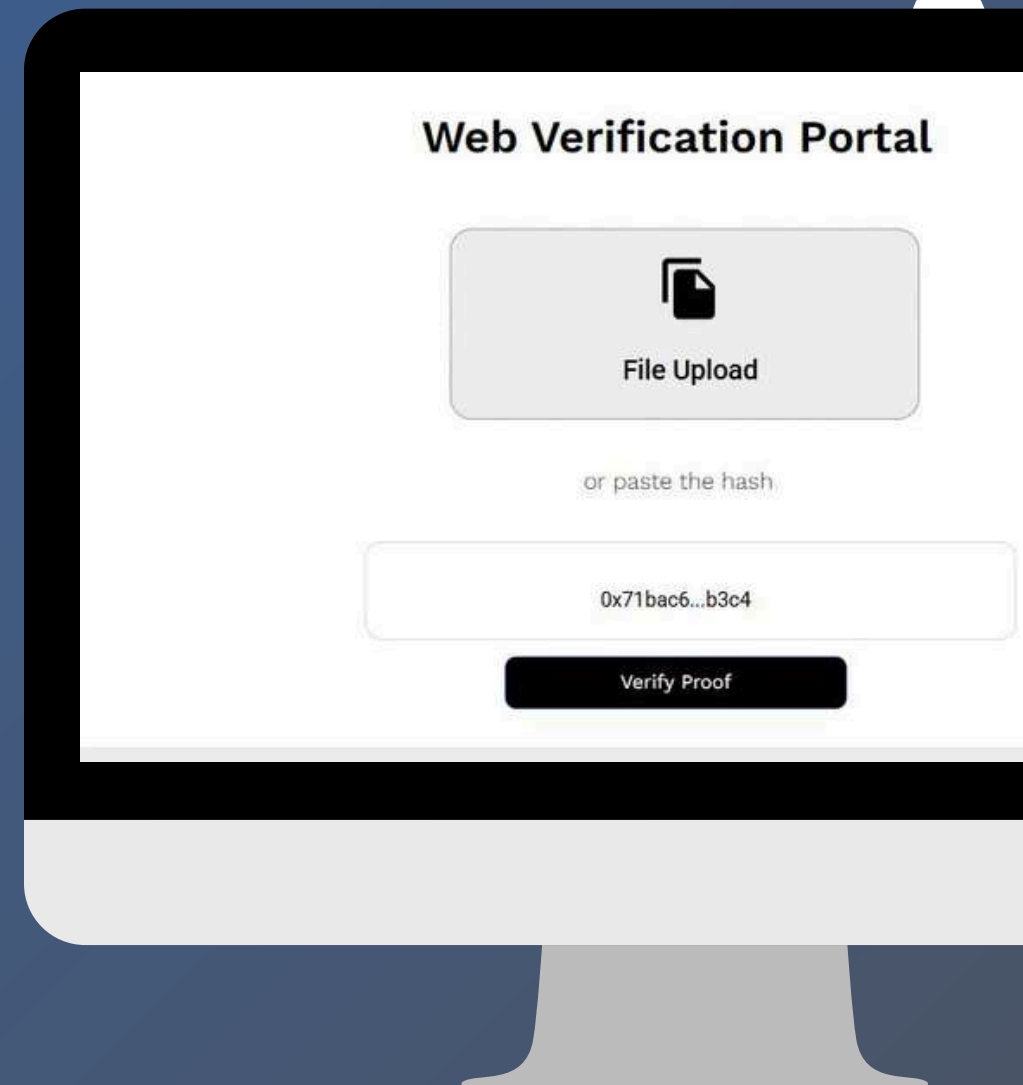
FUNCTIONALITIES

WEB VERIFICATION PORTAL

- Upload Interface: Drag-and-drop verification for media files
- Blockchain Explorer: View authenticity certificates
- Journalist Dashboard: Professional tools for content validation
- API Access: Integration with existing fact-checking workflows

BLOCKCHAIN LAYER (POLYGON)

- Hash Storage: Immutable record of media authenticity
- Timestamp Proof of when content was created
- GeographicValidation: Location confirmation for claimed events
- Smart Contracts: Automated verification protocols
- Polygon → Best balance (cheap, fast, eco-friendly, scalable). Perfect for MVP + hackathon.



Hash Storage

Shows you're securing authenticity at the root level (immutability = trust).



Timestamp Verification

Essential for fighting misinformation; proves when something was created.



Geographic Validation

Adds extra credibility for news/events by confirming where it happened



Smart Contracts

Great touch! Shows automation and transparency (removes bias + manual errors)



Polygon

Perfect choice for MVP + hackathon: low-cost, fast transactions, energy efficient, and scalable

CREATIVE TOOLS

Community Hub

Rumor verification and crowd-sourced fact-checking

Offline Library

Encrypted local storage with sync queue

MIL Learning

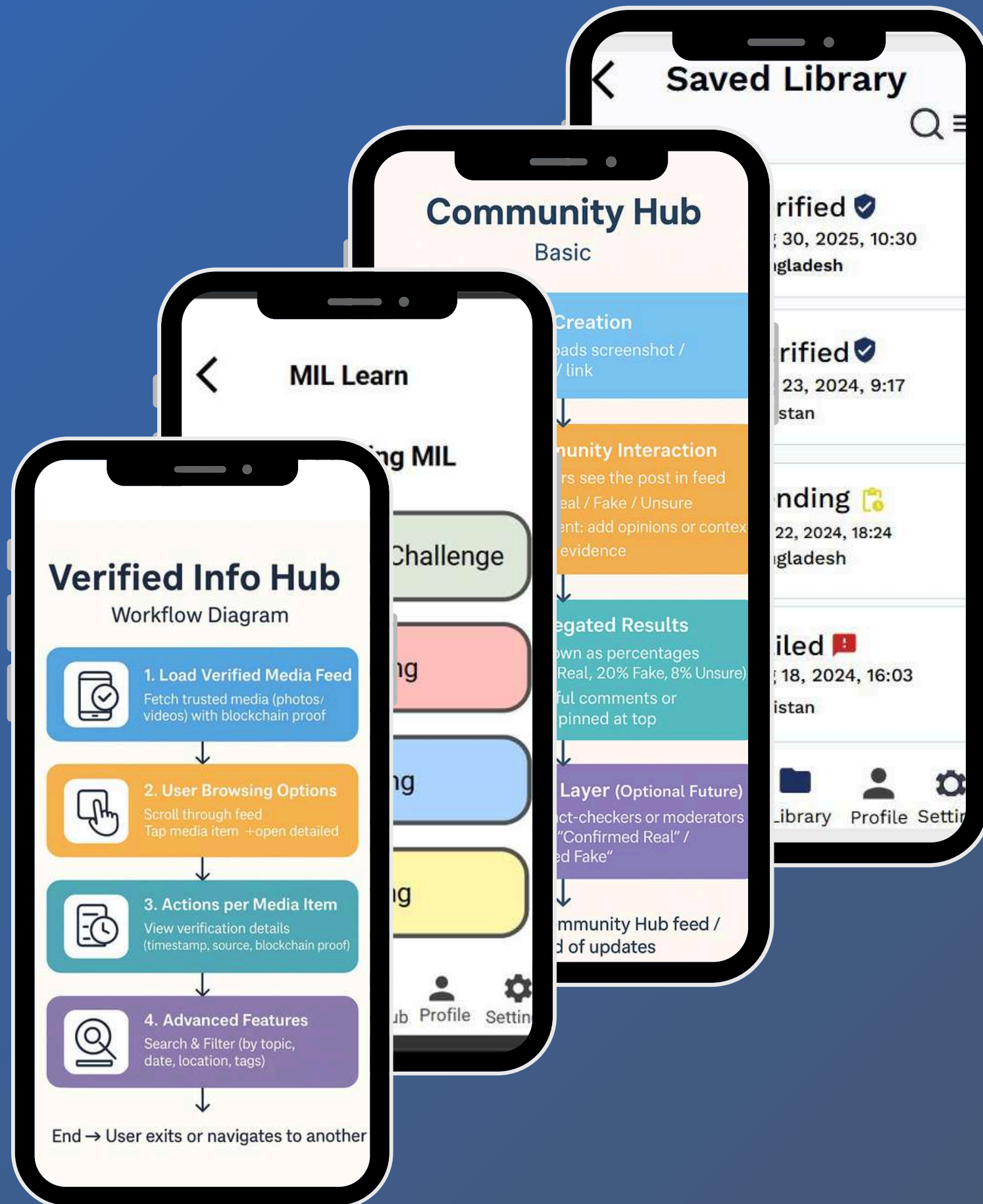
“Spot-the-Fake” challenges and educational games

Capture Module

Camera/video with automatic metadata embedding

Verified Info Hub

A library of trusted media with blockchain proof



SUSTAINABILITY PLAN

Phase 1 : Foundation

(Hackathon + 3 months)

- Goal: Working UI and core features
- Funding: \$5K–15 from hackathon prizes, micro-grants
- Focus: Technical development, initial user testing

Phase 2: Growth

(6 months)

- Goal: 1,000+ active users, regional partnerships
- Funding: \$25K–50K from innovation funds (UNICEF, Mozilla)
- Focus: User acquisition, content partnerships, feature expansion

WHAT MAKES OUTAGESYNC UNIQUE?

1. **First-of-its-kind:** Only blockchain-verified offline media preservation tool
2. **Gamified Learning:** MIL education through interactive challenges
3. **Community-Driven:** Users become verification nodes in trust network
4. **Crisis-Ready:** Built specifically for shutdown scenarios
5. **Global Impact:** Addresses universal problem with local solutions

FEASIBILITY ANALYSIS

Technical Feasibility

- **Proven Technologies:** All components use established, reliable tech stacks
- **Offline-First:** Designed to work without internet connectivity
- **Scalable Architecture:** Can handle millions of users globally
- **Security-Focused:** Multiple layers of encryption and verification

Technical Feasibility

- **Clear Demand:** 283 shutdowns in 2023 show urgent need
- **Underserved Market:** No existing solution addresses this specific problem
- **Strong Partnerships:** NGOs and media organizations eager to collaborate
- **Funding Available:** Growing interest in crisis resilience technology

Thank You!

Power down? Info up.
OutageSync keeps you in
the loop.



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